

Chris and Matt: A Proposal for Working Together

For Matt Campbell, from Chris Habetler. September 29, 2026.

Matt,

First, thank you for asking. I've loved working with you these last few months, and I really appreciate the trust behind it.

On the 22nd you asked what I could do, what it would look like, and what I would charge, so I took a stab at it. You also said we can figure this out together, and that's how I've tried to write it. Read it as a starting point. I'm looking forward to talking it through and finding the best path, and I expect we'll change a good bit of it.

What This Is For

- A clear working arrangement for the two of us. We've both said we want to work together, and I want the terms to match that.
- Helping you build EdTech Expertz into the empire you've talked about.
- The just-right level of support for this moment.
- Adjusting it as we go, so it grows when the business does.

I want to earn my place on your team, and I want you to feel completely comfortable asking me for whatever you need.

The Objective

The objective is to grow EdTech Expertz, in revenue and in impact. Right now the constraint is your time. You're uniquely qualified to do this work, your time is at a premium, and the business is ready to grow, but nobody has a time machine. What helps is the just-right level and type of support, from someone you know, who can add real value right away. That's what lets EdTech Expertz take on AAP and one or more additional clients, and it's a first step.

Everything from here on is a proposal. To be honest, I'm a little nervous putting numbers on paper, because I don't want to get this wrong in either direction, so forgive me in advance if anything here seems presumptuous. The only goal is an arrangement that works well for both of us, and it only works well for me if it works well for you.

How I'd Work

Operating Mindset

I'm in this with you. If it helps EdTech Expertz grow, send it my way, including things neither of us has thought of yet. When you need me, I'm available, with same-day replies and a 48-hour default on requests. Bedtimes and family time are harder, but we'll make it work. This is a startup, and that's part of the deal.

Approximate Time Commitment

About a day a week to start, more in heavy weeks and less in light ones. It's here so you know what's reasonable to ask for, not to draw a line. If it runs well past that for a month or two, we look at the base rate together.

Core Responsibilities

This is what I heard from you on the 22nd.

- Research, with real ownership. You give me the goal and the process, and I come back with more than you asked for: the crosswalk, and also the "here's 30 people at Canvas you should reach out to" version you described. Diligence readouts and prep briefs on prospective clients are part of this too.
- Advisory. The school-side voice in your client work: first meetings with prospective clients, working sessions like Forward Edge on 10/1, messaging and language work, feedback on decks and pitches, and introductions in both directions.
- The referral network. You said it wouldn't just benefit from more help, it needs it. That means recruiting new members, training them on the companies and what each one needs, and checking in on them. The details are ours to work out, and members and clients still go through you.
- Delegation. The things that take your time but not your brain. That starts with the consulting infrastructure you mentioned: the EdTech Expertz ChatGPT workspace, a shared knowledge base in Drive and the workspace so client context lives in one place, the company email, and QuickBooks.

For the first month, my priorities would be prep briefs on your five parked leads, the ChatGPT workspace and knowledge base set up, the network member list cleaned up, and a one-page card on each company.

Worth Considering

- Promotional materials: one-pagers, decks, leave-behinds, and other design work.
- Outreach to the mid-size publishers and platforms on your target list.

Further Out

Representing EdTech Expertz at conferences, working with client teams on how they serve schools, school-leader feedback panels, sales training on how schools buy, procurement help, and AI enablement or L&D. When a client pays for any of this, we agree on my share before it starts.

Ownership

As with any subcontract, anything I create while working with you is yours, prompts included. The one exception is work I do directly for ClassE, which falls under my own agreement with Joe.

Proposed Base Rate

\$3,000 a month, starting October 1 or the day AAP signs, whichever is later. The work starts when the base rate does. Benchmark and Forward Edge on 10/1 are on me either way.

Here's how I got there, since you've been so open with me about your numbers. You said four clients gets you to about \$12,000 a month in profit after taxes, insurance, and retirement. I don't know your revenue, but my guess is that means the business brings in somewhere around \$20,000 to \$25,000 a month. 15% of that, the same rate I'm proposing for new clients, is \$3,000 to \$3,750, and I started at the low end. If I've guessed wrong, or this feels like an overreach, tell me and we'll rein it in.

How It Grows

- New clients: the base rate goes up by 15% of the monthly retainer for each new client EdTech Expertz signs after we start. A new client at \$10,000 a month adds \$1,500, bringing it to \$4,500. When a new retainer signs, tell me the monthly amount and I'll invoice the new number.

- The network: 20% of what EdTech Expertz keeps on deals that come through the referral network. That's the "grows as the sales these individuals bring in grows" piece you described on 9/16. I'll never pitch members, and my own intros stay under our August agreement.
- Projects, courses, and speaking: if I help build one, we agree on my share before it starts.
- Big changes: a very large client, a client leaving, or AAP slipping past October go to our next check-in, not to a formula.

This is the proposal. If it's too big a swing to start, let's find a smaller one. From what I understand, you could use the support, and I sure wouldn't mind a little income.

Checking In

This is meant to be ongoing, not a trial. The weekly check-in, where you set the priorities, handles week to week. In January we'd have our first real sit-down to look at what I delivered, what it freed up for you, and whether the base rate and the time still match the work. After that, we check in every quarter, or anytime either of us wants to.

Either of us can end it with 30 days' notice. The notice month is paid, and you'd get a clean handoff. The network share keeps paying for 12 months on deals already logged.

Items for Conversation

1. A full-time role. I'm in late rounds for a full-time role at a charter network, and there may be others. If one happens, you'll hear it from me first, and I want to keep doing both. The work would move to before and after the school day. What we'd work out together is timing (the network check-ins are the piece most tied to the school day) and anything a school employer would want to clear, since the network puts vendors in front of schools.
2. What you usually keep on a network deal. That number tells us whether 20% is right.
3. How many hours a week research and the network take you now.
4. The ClassE advisory. You asked on 9/16 what I'd need. Joe would pay this directly, so it doesn't touch your ClassE fee or count toward my 15%. My starting thought is \$3,000 a month, and I'd want your read on how to frame it with Joe and where that work ends and my work for you begins.

Thank you again for asking me. Obviously there's a lot here, and I'm really looking forward to talking it through and figuring out what works best for you. Clarity is king, so push on any of it.

Chris